

EXECUTIVE SALES DASHBOARD

Project Case Study

Microsoft Power BI Portfolio Project

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2026

Transforming transactional sales data into executive-level business intelligence through interactive reporting, advanced DAX calculations, and data-driven storytelling.

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1. Executive Overview

Executive Overview

The **Executive Sales Dashboard** is a comprehensive Business Intelligence solution developed using Microsoft Power BI to transform transactional sales data into meaningful, actionable insights. Built using the **Sample Superstore** dataset, the dashboard provides executives and business managers with a centralized platform for monitoring organizational performance through interactive visualizations, advanced DAX calculations, and executive-level reporting.

The project demonstrates the complete Power BI development lifecycle. It begins with data preparation in Power Query, followed by dimensional data modeling using a Star Schema, advanced DAX measure development, interactive dashboard design, performance optimization, and mobile report development. The result is a scalable and executive-ready reporting solution capable of supporting strategic business decisions.

Rather than presenting historical sales figures alone, the dashboard emphasizes business storytelling by integrating dynamic KPIs, time intelligence calculations, executive insights, drill-through functionality, report page tooltips, bookmarks, conditional formatting, and a mobile-optimized reporting experience. These features provide stakeholders with the ability to explore organizational performance interactively while maintaining clarity and analytical context.

This project showcases both technical proficiency in Microsoft Power BI and the ability to communicate business insights through effective data visualization and analytical reporting.

2. Business Problem

Organizations generate significant volumes of transactional sales data every day. While this information contains valuable insights regarding customer behavior, regional performance, product profitability, and sales trends, it is often stored in formats that make executive analysis difficult and time-consuming.

Business leaders require an efficient reporting solution capable of consolidating multiple performance indicators into a single interactive dashboard. Traditional spreadsheet reports are often static, difficult to maintain, and provide limited opportunities for exploratory analysis.

The objective of this project was to develop a modern Business Intelligence solution capable of transforming raw sales transactions into executive-level insights through interactive reporting, enabling faster, more informed, and data-driven decision-making.

3. Project Objectives

The primary objectives of this project were to:

- Develop an executive-level sales dashboard using Microsoft Power BI.
- Build a scalable Star Schema data model.
- Clean and transform data using Power Query.
- Create reusable DAX measures for executive reporting.
- Implement advanced Time Intelligence calculations including:
 - Month-to-Date (MTD)
 - Year-to-Date (YTD)
 - Previous Month Analysis
 - Previous Year Analysis
 - Month-over-Month (MoM) Growth

- Year-over-Year (YoY) Growth
- Design an intuitive dashboard emphasizing usability and executive decision-making.
- Implement drill-through pages and report page tooltips.
- Create dynamic report titles and executive insight cards.
- Optimize dashboard performance using Power BI best practices.
- Develop a responsive mobile dashboard.
- Produce a portfolio-quality Business Intelligence solution suitable for professional presentation.

4. Dataset Overview

Dataset Description

The project uses the **Sample Superstore** dataset, a widely recognized retail sales dataset containing transactional records for customer orders, products, sales, discounts, profits, and geographical locations.

The dataset provides a realistic business environment for analyzing sales performance and developing executive reporting solutions.

Core Data Entities

Table	Purpose
Customers	Customer information and market segments
Orders	Order-level transaction records
Order Details	Sales, Profit, Quantity and Discount metrics
Products	Product hierarchy and categories
Locations	Geographic information including Region, State and City
Date Table	Calendar dimension supporting Time Intelligence calculations

Data Preparation

The dataset was prepared using Microsoft Power Query. Key preparation tasks included:

- Data validation
- Column formatting
- Data type correction
- Relationship preparation
- Date dimension creation

- Removal of inconsistencies
- Optimization for analytical reporting

5. Solution Architecture

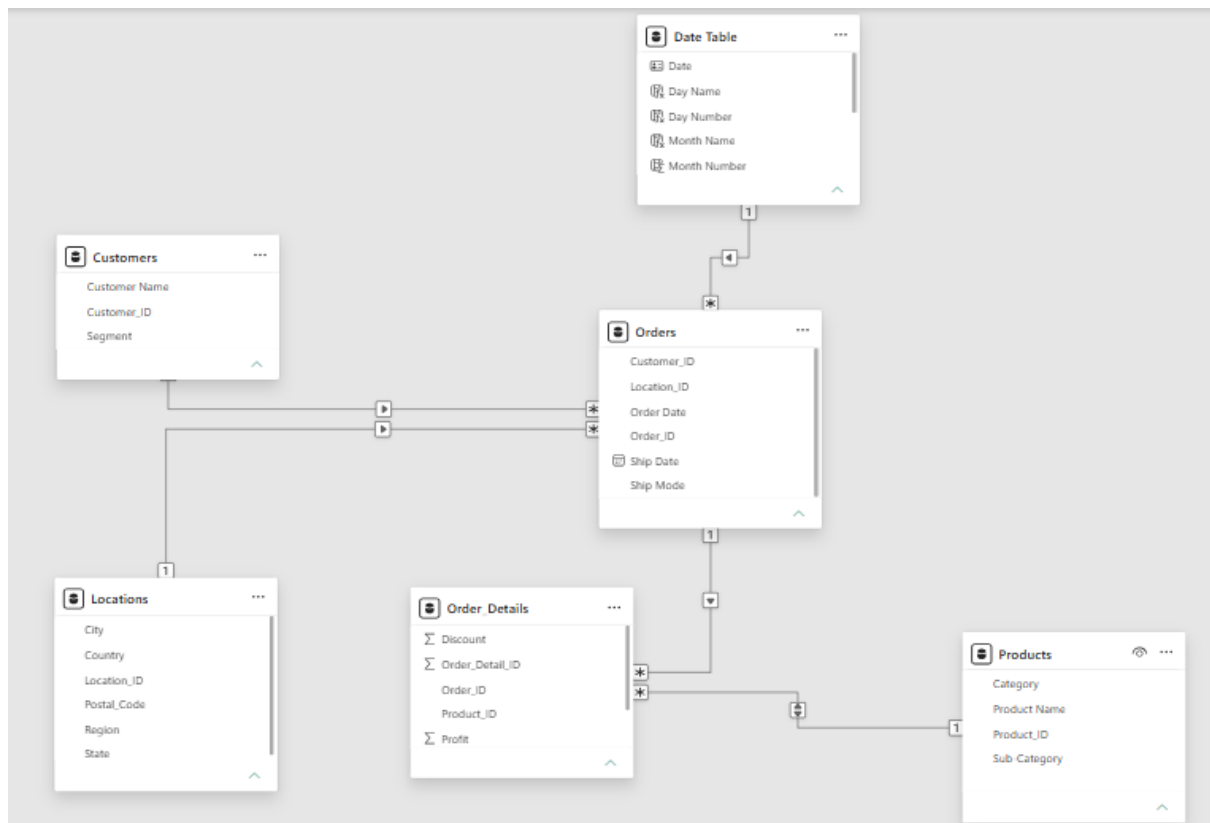


Figure 1. Star Schema Data Model

The dashboard follows a Star Schema architecture consisting of two central fact tables (Orders and Order Details) connected to supporting dimension tables (Customers, Products, Locations, and Date Table). This model simplifies analytical queries, improves report performance, and supports scalable DAX calculations.

Data Flow

Sample Superstore Dataset

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Power Query

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Star Schema

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DAX Measures

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Executive Dashboard

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Business Insights

This architecture follows Business Intelligence best practices by separating transactional data from descriptive dimensions, enabling efficient filtering and accurate analytical calculations.

6. Dashboard Features

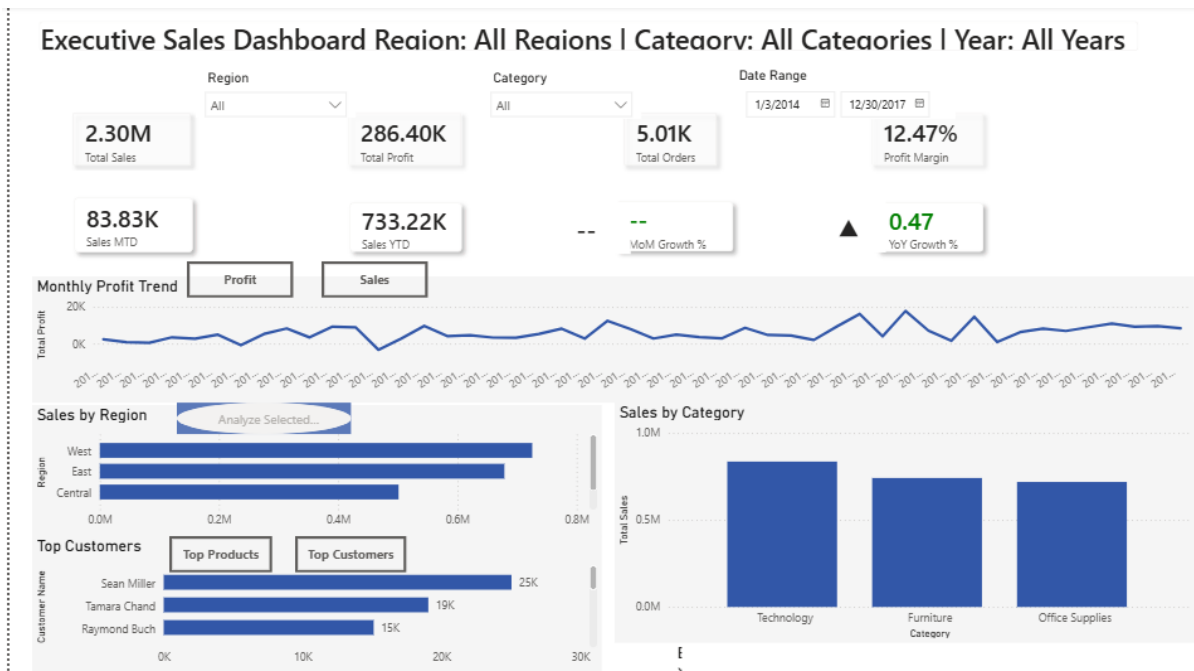


Figure 2. Executive Sales Dashboard

The dashboard provides a comprehensive executive reporting experience through a combination of interactive visuals, advanced calculations, and user-friendly navigation.

Feature	Business Purpose
Executive KPI Cards	Monitor key business metrics including Sales, Profit, Orders and Profit Margin
Time Intelligence	Analyze Month-to-Date, Year-to-Date, MoM and YoY performance
Interactive Slicers	Enable users to filter reports dynamically by Region, Category and Year

Feature	Business Purpose
Dynamic Dashboard Title	Reflect the current report context automatically
Executive Insight Cards	Translate numerical results into business-friendly narratives
Drill-through Pages	Navigate from summary information to detailed analysis
Report Page Tooltips	Provide contextual information without cluttering the dashboard
KPI Indicators	Highlight performance trends using conditional formatting
Mobile Dashboard	Provide an optimized experience for smartphone users
Performance Optimization	Improve report responsiveness and resource utilization

7. Technical Skills Demonstrated

This project demonstrates proficiency across multiple areas of Business Intelligence development.

Category	Skills Demonstrated
Data Preparation	Power Query, Data Cleaning, Data Transformation
Data Modeling	Star Schema, Relationships, Date Dimension
DAX Development	Aggregations, Time Intelligence, Dynamic Reporting
Visualization	KPI Cards, Charts, Slicers, Conditional Formatting
User Experience	Drill-through, Tooltips, Bookmarks, Buttons
Performance Optimization	Performance Analyzer, Memory Optimization, Auto Date/Time Management
Mobile Reporting	Responsive Mobile Dashboard Design

8. Business Value

The Executive Sales Dashboard delivers measurable value by providing business stakeholders with timely, interactive, and data-driven insights.

Key business benefits include:

- Centralized monitoring of organizational performance.
- Improved visibility into sales and profitability trends.
- Enhanced regional and product category analysis.
- Faster executive decision-making through interactive reporting.

- Reduction in manual reporting effort.
- Improved accessibility through mobile reporting.
- Support for strategic planning using historical performance analysis.

By consolidating key performance indicators into a single reporting environment, the dashboard enables executives to focus on decision-making rather than data preparation.

9. Project Outcomes

The successful completion of this project resulted in:

- A fully interactive Executive Sales Dashboard.
- A scalable Star Schema data model.
- Advanced DAX calculations supporting executive reporting.
- Interactive analytical capabilities including drill-through and report page tooltips.
- Mobile-optimized reporting.
- Performance-optimized Power BI implementation.
- Comprehensive project documentation.
- A portfolio-quality Business Intelligence solution demonstrating both technical and business competencies.

10. Conclusion

The Executive Sales Dashboard demonstrates the complete development lifecycle of a modern Business Intelligence solution using Microsoft Power BI. Through the integration of data preparation, dimensional modeling, advanced DAX calculations, interactive visualization, performance optimization, and mobile reporting, the project transforms transactional sales data into meaningful insights that support executive decision-making.

Beyond its technical implementation, the dashboard reflects an understanding of how Business Intelligence should be applied to solve real-world business challenges. By combining analytical rigor with user-centered design, the solution provides executives with a powerful tool for monitoring performance, identifying trends, and making informed strategic decisions.

As a professional portfolio project, the Executive Sales Dashboard showcases not only technical expertise in Microsoft Power BI but also the ability to communicate business value effectively through structured documentation, interactive reporting, and data-driven storytelling.

Appendix

Software & Technologies Used

Technology	Purpose
Microsoft Power BI Desktop	Dashboard Development
Power Query	Data Cleaning and Transformation
DAX	Business Calculations and Time Intelligence
Star Schema	Data Modeling
Power BI Service	Dashboard Publishing
GitHub	Portfolio Hosting